NNN-M-560
October 26, 1962

SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. GG-M-631b
November 10, 1958

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

MORTAR AND PESTLE

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 **Scope.** The mortars and pestles covered by this specification shall be used for pharmaceutical, dental, and general laboratory use. Rubber tipped pestles are for soil testing use.

1.2 **Classification.**

1.2.1 *Types, classes, styles, and sizes.* Mortars and pestles shall be furnished in the following types, classes, styles, and sizes or capacities, as specified (see 6.2).

1.2.2 *Mortars and pestles.*

Type I—Porcelain.
- Class A—Glazed outside.
- Class B—Unglazed (Wedgewood).

Type II—Glass.
- Class A—Regular.
- Class B—Dental.
  - Style 1—With inside mound.
  - Style 2—Without inside mound.

Type III—Mullite.

Type IV—Cast iron.

1.2.3 *Mortar sizes or capacities.*

Type I, class A—capacity 60, 90, 135, 275, 400, 750, 1900, 4000 milliliters.

Type I, class B—capacity 60, 100, 150, 165, 300, 415, 770, 1185, 1650, 2840, 4730 milliliters.

Type II, class A—capacity 2, 4, 8, 16, 32 ounces.

Type III—size 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7.

1.2.4 *Pestles.*

Type V—Wood, rubber tipped.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 **Specifications and standards.** The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications.

QQ-I-666—Iron Castings, Malleable.

PPP-B-601—Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.

PPP-B-621—Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.

PPP-B-636—Box, Fiberboard.

PPP-C-843—Cushioning Material, Cellulosic.

PPP-T-76—Tape, Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive Paper, Water Resistent, (For Carton Sealing).

FSC 6640

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Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.

Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, and Auburn, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

Uniform Freight Classification Rules.

(Application for copies should be addressed to Uniform Classification Committee, 202 Union Station, Chicago 6, Illinois.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials.

3.1.1 *Type I.* Type I mortars and pestles, except handle of class B pestle, shall be made of high quality porcelain having an average coefficient of expansion between 20° and 200°C. of 0.0000036 centimeters (cm)/cm/1°C., gradually increasing to 0.0000047 cm/cm/1°C. at 1000°C. Softening point shall be at not less than 1400°C., and fusion point shall be at not less than 1670°C. Porcelain shall be subjected to two firings to insure uniformity. The handle of the class B pestle shall be made of high quality, straight grained, sound, thoroughly seasoned hickory, birch, ash, or hard maple, which shall be free from knots or other imperfections.

3.1.2 *Type II.* Type II mortars and pestles shall be made of good quality glass. The glass shall be clear and transparent but may show a faint color. It may contain a few scattered bubbles not exceeding 0.05 inch in diameter if the bubbles are not within 1/32 inch of the grinding surface. Open bubbles, blisters, or cracks on any surface are not permitted.

3.1.3 *Type III.* Type III mortars and pestles shall be made of mullite which is an aluminum silicate compound fired at temperatures above 3000°F. providing a smooth white homogeneous grinding surface.

3.1.4 *Type IV.* Type IV mortars and pestles shall be made of cast iron in accordance with grade I or II of QQ-I-666.

3.1.5 *Type V pestles.* Type V pestles shall be made of wood and rubber. The wood shall be high quality, straight grained, sound, thoroughly seasoned hickory, birch, ash, or hard maple, which shall be free from knots and other imperfections. The rubber shall be of good quality with a minimum Moh hardness of 1 and a maximum Moh hardness of 2.

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3.2 Construction, mortars and pestles.

3.2.1 *Type I, class A and type II, class A.* Mortars shall have the proper inside curvature to facilitate grinding. The walls of the respective mortars shall be sufficiently heavy to withstand the ordinary usage for which they are intended. The base shall be flat and of sufficient diameter to give a firm and stable resting surface. The brim of type I, class A, shall be flat and shall have a well-formed pouring lip. All edges of type II, class A, shall be rounded and mortars shall have well-formed pouring lips. The mortars shall pour evenly when tested as specified in 4.6.1. The pestles shall be of such design as to afford a comfortable manual grip. The grinding end shall be properly rounded to facilitate grinding.

3.2.2 *Type I, class B.* Mortars shall have the proper inside curvature to facilitate grinding. The walls of the respective mortars shall be sufficiently heavy to withstand the ordinary usage for which they are intended. The base shall be flat and of sufficient diameter to give a firm and stable resting surface. All edges shall be rounded. The mortars shall have well-formed pouring lips, and shall pour evenly when tested as specified in 4.6.1. The pestle shall be of such design as to afford a comfortable manual grip. The grinding end shall be properly rounded to facilitate grinding. The handle shall be properly and permanently secured to the grinding head. The union between these two parts shall not loosen when tested as specified in 4.6.4.

3.2.3 *Type II, class B.* The mortar shall have a flat base with all edges beveled or rounded. The style 1 mortar shall have a mound on the inside floor to aid in trituration. The style 2 mortar shall have a well-rounded inside curvature. The pestle shall have a comfortable handgrip with at least one side of the handle end flat to prevent it from rolling off a slightly tilted flat surface.

3.2.4 *Type III.* Mortars shall have the proper inside curvature to facilitate grinding. The walls of the respective mortars shall be sufficiently heavy to withstand the ordinary usage for which they are intended. The base shall be flat and of sufficient diameter to give a firm and stable resting surface. The outer surface shall be hexagonal with flat planes forming the surfaces of the hexagonal shape. The top shall be flat. The pestles shall be of such design as to afford a comfortable manual grip. The grinding end shall be properly rounded to facilitate grinding.

3.2.5 *Type IV.* Mortars shall have a conical shaped cavity rounded at the bottom. The side walls of the mortar shall be progressively thicker near the bottom and sufficiently heavy to withstand the ordinary usage for which they are intended. The base shall be flat and of sufficient diameter to give a firm and stable resting surface. The pestle shall be of such design as to afford a comfortable grip. The grinding end shall be properly rounded to facilitate grinding.

3.2.6 *Type V (pestle, only).* The pestle shall be of wood with a rubber-tipped grinding end. The handle shall be of wood in accordance with 3.1.5 and of such design as to afford a comfortable manual grip. The grinding end shall be of rubber in accordance with 3.1.5, properly rounded to facilitate grinding. The handle shall be properly and permanently secured to the grinding end so as to pass the pestle test of 3.2.2 when tested in accordance with 4.6.4.

3.3 Capacities and dimensions.

3.3.1 *Type I, class A.* Mortars shall be furnished in the capacities and shall be of the dimensions as indicated in table I. The diameter of the pestle shall be in accordance with good commercial practice and the length shall comply with the requirements in table I.

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TABLE I.

Mortar			Pestle
Capacity[1]	Top outside diameter[2]	Height[2]	Overall length[2]
Milliliter	*Millimeter*	*Millimeter*	*Millimeter*
60	70	42	110
90	80	48	130
185	90	58	135
275	115	70	170
400	130	80	190
400	150	82	165
750	160	100	220
1,900	210	130	240
4,000	283	150	260

[1]Tolerance: + 10 percent.
[2]Tolerances: ± 5 percent.

3.3.2 *Type I, class B.* Mortars shall be furnished in the capacities and shall be of the dimensions as indicated in table II. The diameter of the pestle shall be in accordance with good commercial practice and the length shall comply with the requirements in table II.

TABLE II.

Mortar			Pestle
Capacity[1]	Top outside diameter[2]	Height[2]	Overall length[2]
Milliliter	*Millimeter*	*Millimeter*	*Millimeter*
60	82	54	127
100	90	56	127
150	100	64	150
165	115	70	158
300	127	73	178
415	140	86	185
770	162	98	203
1,185	186	105	238
1,650	206	118	254
2,840	248	130	293
4,730	287	150	330

[1]Tolerance: + 10 percent.
[2]Tolerances: ± 5 percent.

3.3.3 *Type II, class A.* Mortars shall be furnished in the capacities and shall be of the dimensions as indicated in table III. The diameter of the pestle shall be in accordance with good commercial practice and the length shall comply with the requirements in table III.

TABLE III.

Mortar		Pestle
Capacity[1]	Top outside diameter[2]	Over-all length[2]
Ounces	*Inches*	*Inches*
2	3-1/8	4
4	3-1/2	5
8	4-1/4	6
16	5-1/4	7-1/2
32	8-1/4	9-3/5

[1]Tolerance: + 10 percent.
[2]Tolerances: ± 5 percent.

3.3.4 *Type II, class B.* The mortar and pestle shall comply with the design, capacity, and dimensions shown in figure 1. Dimensions not shown shall be approximately in proportion with those indicated in the figure.

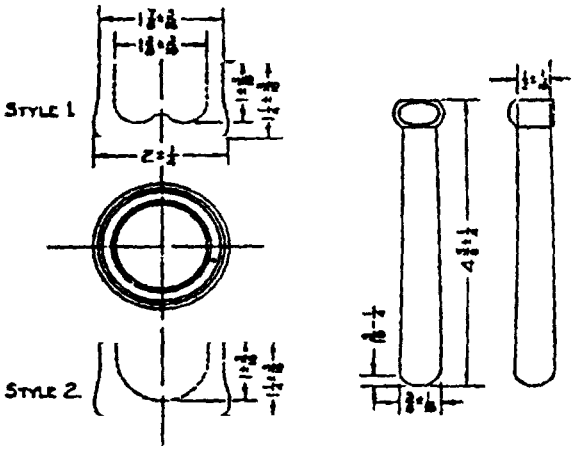


FIGURE 1.—Type II, class B, glass dental mortars and pestles (All dimensions in inches).

3.3.5 *Type III.* The mortars shall be furnished in the capacities and shall be of the dimensions as indicated in table IV. The diameter of the pestle shall be in accordance with good commercial practice and the length shall comply with the requirements in table IV.

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TABLE IV.

Size	Mortar			Pestle
	Outside[1] dia.	Working[1] dia.	Height[1]	Length[1]
	Millimeter	Millimeter	Millimeter	Millimeter
1	35	26	18	38
2	50	38	26	57
3	65	54	31	65
4	75	68	37	75
5	90	77	42	90
6	100	86	47	100
7	120	102	57	120

[1]Tolerance: ± 5 percent.

3.3.6 *Type IV.* The mortar and pestle shall be of the capacity and dimensions as indicated in table V.

3.3.7 *Type V (pestle, only).* The diameter of the pestle shall be in accordance with good commercial practice; the length shall be 8 inches ± 5 percent.

3.4 Finish.

3.4.1 *Type I, class B.* All porcelain surfaces shall be unglazed. The handles of the pestles shall be natural wood finish without the application of shellac or varnish.

3.4.2 *Type II, class A.* All surfaces of the mortar and pestle shall be finished smooth.

3.4.3 *Type II, class B.* Inside surface of mortar and grinding end of pestle shall be properly etched and sandblasted. Other surfaces shall be etched or frosted.

3.4.4 *Type IV.* Inside surface of mortar and grinding end of the pestle shall be ground smooth.

3.5 Glazing.

3.5.1 *Type I, class A.* The outside diameter of the mortar, except the base, and the outside of the pestle, except the grinding end, shall be glazed with a smooth, brilliant, hard white coating. There shall be no appreciable dulling of the glazed surfaces when tested as specified in 4.6.3.

3.5.2 *Type III.* The outside of the mortar shall be glazed. Inside surface of mortar and grinding surface of pestle shall be polished. There shall be no appreciable dulling of the glazed surfaces when tested as specified in 4.6.3.

3.6 Heat resistance (type I, and type III). No cracks shall show on the surface of the mortar and pestle when tested as specified in 4.6.2.

3.7 Solubility (type II). No watermark shall remain on the surface of the mortar and pestle, nor pink color develop in the test solution when tested as specified in 4.6.5.

3.8 Boiling (type II). The mortar and pestle shall show no evidence of corrosion, scumming, chipping, or cracking when tested as specified in 4.6.6.

3.9 Marking. Each mortar shall be permanently and legibly marked on the outside with the name or trademark of the manufacturer.

TABLE V.

Mortar[1]				Pestle[1]	
Diameter of top, inches (in.)		Height, in.		Length, in.	Diameter of base, in.
Outside	Inside	Outside	Inside		
6	5-1/2	5-9/16	5-5/16	8	1-7/8

[1]Dimensional tolerance: ± 5 percent.

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3.10 Workmanship. Mortars and pestles shall be symmetrical in shape, uniform in size, and free from cracks, specks, and other defects or contamination (grease, oil, foreign matter) which will affect their appearance or which may affect their serviceability.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 The supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examination and tests shall be kept complete and available to the Government as specified in the contract or order. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Special provisions.

4.2.1 *Alternative inspection (including testing) procedures.* The supplier may utilize any alternative inspection procedure which will assure equal or better quality by submitting a written proposal with justification and obtaining written approval from the Government prior to instituting the procedure. In case of dispute, the procedures of this specification will govern.

4.2.2 *Supplemental evidence.* The supplier shall provide evidence acceptable to the contracting officer that the requirements of 3.1.1, 3.1.2, 3.1.3, 3.1.4, 3.1.5 and section 5 have been satisfied.

4.3 Lotting. A lot shall consist of those mortars and pestles of the same type, class, style, and size or capacity, made by one manufacturer and submitted for delivery at one time.

4.4 Sampling.

4.4.1 *For nondestructive examination.* Sampling shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.4.2 *For test.* Unless otherwise specified, two mortars and pestles for each type, class, and style shall be taken at random from each delivery of 500 or fraction thereof.

4.5 Examination. Sample mortars and pestles and level A and level B preparation for delivery requirements shall be examined in accordance with the classification of defects and with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 *Classification of defects.*

4.5.1.1 *Mortars and pestles.*

Categories	*Defects*
Critical:	None defined
Major:	*AQL 4.0 percent defective*
101	Dimensions incorrect.
102	Style incorrect.
103	Not symmetrical or uniform in size.
104	Defects (cracks, specks, scratches).
105	Marking missing, incorrect, or illegible.
106	Contamination (grease, oil, foreign matter).

4.5.1.2 *Level A and B preparation for delivery (section 5).*

Categories	*Defects*
Critical:	None defined
Major:	*AQL 2.5 percent defective*
101	Unit or shipping containers incorrect.
102	Cushioning or bracing incorrect.
103	Closure of unit or shipping containers incorrect.
104	Unlike mortars and pestles packed per container
105	Unit or shipping containers damaged.
106	Marking of unit or shipping containers illegible, incorrect, or incomplete

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4.6 Tests. Distilled water and analytical reagent grade chemicals shall be used throughout the tests. Tests shall be conducted as follows:

4.6.1. *Pour test (type I, classes A and B, and type II, class A).* Fill the mortar to indicated capacity with water. Pour approximately one-fourth of the water from the mortar at such a rate that the water flows in a continuous stream and falls free from the lip of the mortar. If the stream of water clings to the outside of the mortar and flows off the bottom, it shall be considered cause for rejection.

4.6.2 *Heat resistance (type I and type III).* Mortar and pestle, for test, shall be filled with high-flash cylinder oil, heated to 125° ± 2°C. The oil shall be rapidly poured out, the excess oil removed with a swab, and the mortar cooled by immersing in water at 25° ± 2°C. The time lapse between removing the mortar and oil from the heat source and immersion of the mortar in water shall not exceed 30 seconds.

4.6.3 *Chemical test for glazing (type I, class A and type III).* The glazed surfaces of the mortar and pestle shall be treated for 6 hours with a 10 percent solution of sodium hydroxide on a steam plate.

4.6.4 *Boiling test (type I, class B).* Pestles shall be completely immersed in distilled water in a closed vessel having a small steam vent and boiled for 1 hour, boiling distilled water being added when necessary to compensate for evaporation losses.

4.6.5 *Solubility (type II).* Mortars and pestles taken for test shall be well cleaned and then rinsed three times with distilled water, a new quantity of distilled water being used for each rinsing. The mortars and pestles shall be air-dried in an inverted position for 1 minute after each rinsing. After the final drying operation, mortar containing pestle shall be half filled with distilled water at 60°C. plus or minus 2°C., containing 0.2 percent phenolphthalein test solution (prepared from 1 gram phenolphthalein in 100 ml. alcohol) and allowed to stand at room temperature for 1 hour. Suitable means shall be provided to exclude atmospheric CO_2. The distilled water used in this test shall have just been boiled for 10 minutes in a flask (which in itself will not affect the test solution) and allowed to cool (preferably without excessive agitation but with mild stirring with a thermometer) to 60°C., prior to the addition of the phenolphthalein test solution.

4.6.6 *Boiling test (type II).* The mortars and pestles shall be completely immersed in distilled water in a closed vessel having a small steam vent and boiled continuously for 6 hours, boiling water being added when necessary to compensate for evaporation losses. The mortars and pestles shall be suspended in the water so that they do not come in contact with the containing vessel.

4.7 Acceptance/rejection criteria. If any mortar and pestle fails to meet the test requirements of this specification, the lot represented shall be rejected.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

For civil agency procurement the definitions and applications of the levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 102.

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 *Level A.* One mortar and one pestle of the type and class specified shall constitute one unit. Each unit shall be packaged in a box of appropriate size conforming to type I, class 1, of PPP-B-636. The box shall be provided with suitable interior fittings or shall contain sufficient cushioning material conforming to type II, class B of PPP-C-843 to prevent shifting of or damage to contents. Box closures shall be secured with tape conforming to PPP-T-76.

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5.1.2 *Level C.* Mortars and pestles shall be packaged in accordance with the manufacturer's commercial practice suitable for shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity for immediate use.

5.2 **Packing.** Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 *Level A.* Mortars and pestles shall be packed in shipping containers conforming to PPP-B-601, overseas type or PPP-B-621, class 2. Containers shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the applicable box specification and appendix thereto. The gross weight of the shipping container shall not exceed 200 pounds.

5.2.2 *Level B.* Mortars and pestles shall be packed in shipping containers conforming to PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class I; or PPP-B-636, type I or II, class 1, style RSC, minimum bursting strength 275 pounds per square inch. Containers shall be closed and strapped in accordance with the applicable box specification and appendix thereto. The gross weight of the shipping container shall not exceed the weight limitations of the applicable box specification.

5.2.3 *Level C.* Mortars and pestles shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at first domestic destination. Containers shall be in accordance with Uniform Freight Classfication Rules or regulations of other carriers as applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 *Military agencies.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, unit packages, intermediate packages, and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 **Intended use.** Mortars and pestles purchased under this specification are for pharmaceutical, dental, and general laboratory use. Rubber tipped pestles are for soil testing use.

6.2 **Ordering data.** Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(b) Level of packaging and packing required.

(c) Type, class, style, and capacity or size of mortar and pestle required.

6.3 **Military use.** Items procured under this specification for military use are to be limited to the variety shown on the applicable military standard and military supply standard. Personnel of the military departments are requested to refer to these documents for guidance.

6.4 It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine conformance to the requirements of this specification. If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

6.5 Federal specifications do not include all types, classes, grades, sizes, etc., of the commodities indicated by the titles of the specifications or which are commercially available, but are intended to cover the types, etc., which are suitable for Federal Government requirements.

6.6 **Transportation description.** Transportation description applicable to this item is:

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Type I:

Porcelainware, not otherwise indexed by name. (Specify released valuation).
Carload minimum weights 24,000 and 20,000 pounds, subject to Rule 34, Uniform Freight Classification.
Porcelainware, not otherwise indexed. (Specify released valuation.)
Motor volume minimum weight 24,000 pounds.

Type II:

Glassware, not otherwise indexed by name. (Specify actual valuation.)
Carload minimum weights 24,000 and 20,000 pounds, subject to Rule 34, Uniform Freight Classification.
Glassware, not otherwise indexed. (Specify actual valuation.)
Truckload minimum weights 24,000 and 20,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight classification.

Type III:

Aluminum articles, not otherwise indexed.
Truckload minimum weight 14,000 pounds subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.
Aluminum articles, not otherwise indexed by name.
Carload minimum weights 14,000 and 24,000 pounds, subject to Rule 34, Uniform Freight Classification.

Type IV:

Mortars, hand, iron, with and without pestles.
Carload minimum weight 30,000 pounds.
Mortars, hand, iron, with and without pestles.
Motor volume minimum weight 30,000 pounds.

Type V:

Woodenware, not otherwise indexed by name.
Carload minimum weight 15,000 pounds, subject to Rule 34, Uniform Freight Classification.
Woodenware, not otherwise indexed.
Motor volume minimum weight 15,000 pounds.

Notice. When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY CUSTODIANS:

Army—MU

Navy—Md

Air Force—DAY

Other Interest:

Army—M E O

Copies of this specification may be purchased for 10 cents each.

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